GAMSA · Gender-Affirming Medicines South Australia

Blood test guide: GnRH analogues

GnRH analogues (goserelin, leuprorelin, triptorelin) · gamsa.au/monitoring

Key points Young people: a bone scan before starting and hormone checks at 6 months. Adults: a bone scan only with risk factors.

Applies to me	Test	When	Aim	Talk to your prescriber if
☐	**Bone density scan and bone age (young people)**	Before starting, then as the specialist team decides during treatment	To track bone strength while puberty is paused	A scan is overdue, or you have questions about your bones
☐	**Hormone levels: LH, FSH, and oestradiol or testosterone (young people)**	Before starting; at 6 months, just before the third dose of goserelin or leuprorelin, to check puberty is paused; then every 12 months	LH and FSH low, showing the blocker is working	You notice signs of puberty restarting, or a dose was late
☐	**Bone density scan (adults)**	Not routine. Considered with risk factors, including long-term use, or a blocker taken without oestrogen or testosterone	—	You have been on a blocker for a long time without oestrogen or testosterone
☐	**Heart tracing (ECG) and electrolytes**	If you have a heart rhythm condition or heart failure, or take medicines that affect heart rhythm; then considered periodically	—	You start a medicine that affects heart rhythm

A guide to what to expect, not a schedule to follow on your own. Your prescriber sets the timing.

Reading your results

- Lab reports mark results as high or low using the sex on your Medicare or lab record. On hormones, that range may not fit your body. In the first year your prescriber may ask the lab for both the male and the female ranges.
- A single flagged result is a reason to talk with your prescriber, not to change a dose on your own.
- Units: Australian labs report oestradiol in pmol/L, testosterone in nmol/L, and haematocrit as a fraction (0.50 L/L is the same as 50%).

Sources: RCH standards 2023 pp27-28, Appendix 1; AusPATH 2026 pp42-43; Zoladex PI s4.4, s4.5. Full references and detail for clinicians: gamsa.au/monitoring.

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